

“Just one thing,” the man said. “How are you planning to get back across?”

Bill was suddenly struck by the same thought. “How are we going to get back across with no money?”

“I have an aunt who lives just off the interstate,” Andrea volunteered. “We’ll go see her; it’s just a few miles up. I’m sure she will help.”

With a sinking feeling inside, Bill drove across the bridge and into New Jersey. He realized that what they were doing didn’t make any sense, but he didn’t know what else to do. Andrea was totally committed to the idea of marriage. He was too, but he had some reservations about the timing. The thought crossed his mind that he was acting like a pushover.

They drove to Andrea’s aunt’s home. She was speechless when Andrea called her to say they were only a couple of miles away. But she asked them to come over and began to prepare some lunch.

When Andrea and Bill rang the doorbell, she opened it to find two worn-out and totally rumpled young people. “Andrea, come in,” she said. “Who is your young man, and what in the world brings you here?”

“This is Bill, Aunt Maye,” she said. “We’re getting married and just dropped by to see you.”

“Getting married?” Andrea’s aunt said with surprise. “Does your mom know about this?”

“Well, no. She’s really been depressed since Daddy’s death, and we thought it would be better to elope and not put her through the stress of a wedding.”

“Well, I can’t argue that she’s in no shape for any more emotional trauma,” her aunt said. “But I don’t know that running away to get married is the right answer. Do your parents know, Bill?”

“No, ma’am,” he replied shyly. “But we are of legal age, and my folks know we plan to get married in the summer.”

“Then why all the rush?” she asked.